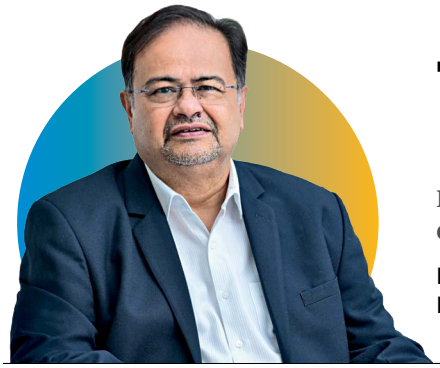


The New MBA: Master of Business Ambiguity

Looking at five habits the future-ready MBA students should develop to navigate an AI world

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OVER THE NEXT five years, we will witness a radical reimagining of what an MBA means. I often say that the degree is slowly becoming a "Master of Business Ambiguity". The managers of tomorrow will not merely solve known problems; they will navigate unknown terrain, architect new ecosystems, and sometimes redefine the problems themselves.

AI is accelerating this transformation. But AI is not merely a technological disruption; it is a disruption of how we learn, work, and lead. This is why the debate about whether AI will make the MBA irrelevant is perhaps asking the wrong question. The more important question is: What should an MBA student become in a world where machines can increasingly know more, process more, and predict more?

The answer begins with judgement.

As information becomes abundant, information itself becomes less valuable. What becomes scarce is the ability to distinguish signal from noise, question an apparently convincing answer, understand context, and make a responsible decision. Discernment, creativity, empathy, ethical reasoning, and wisdom will become increasingly important precisely because machines can generate information at unprecedented speed.

The question, therefore, is no longer "Can students use AI?" It is: Can they question, evaluate, and responsibly use what AI produces?

The future-ready MBA student has traditionally been somewhat answer-centred: understand a framework, analyse a case, and arrive at an answer. The AI era demands a shift towards question-centred learning. When answers are available at the click of a button, the quality of the question becomes a competitive advantage.

A FUTURE LEADER WILL HAVE TO ORCHESTRATE HUMAN AND MACHINE INTELLIGENCE WHILE RETAINING ACCOUNTABILITY FOR THE DECISION

should develop five habits.

First, become AI-fluent, not AI-dependent. Learn how AI works, where it works well, and where it fails. Use it to explore ideas, analyse data, challenge assumptions, simulate scenarios, and improve productivity. But never outsource your judgement to a machine. An AI-generated answer is a starting point for thinking, not a substitute for thinking.

Second, learn to ask better questions. Management education Students should learn to ask: What are we missing? What assumptions are embedded here? Who benefits? What could go wrong? What should we do, even if we can do something else?

Third, use internships, projects, and the first job as laboratories for ambiguity. Students should seek assignments where the problem is real, the data is imperfect, and the answer is not available in a textbook. A project that teaches someone to make a decision with